

Masking-Tape Letter Roads

📍 Living room ⏱ 20 min 👧 Ages 3–5

You need

- Masking tape or painter's tape
- Toy cars

Steps

1. Tape a giant letter on the floor (start with the first letter of your child's name).
2. Drive a toy car along the letter, saying its sound: 'mmm' for M.
3. Add more letters to make a road map. Can they drive to the letter that says 'sss'?
4. Peel the tape off; it won't mark the tiles.

💡 Say the sound, not the letter name: 'buh', not 'bee'.

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐



Lift & Lobby Reading Hunt

📍 Your building ⏱ 10 min 👧 Ages 3–8

You need

- Your eyes!
- Optional: the printable hunt list

Steps

1. In the lift, ask your child to find and press your floor number.
2. Spot letters on signs: EXIT, PUSH, PULL, LOBBY, G for ground.
3. Older kids can read the whole sign and tell you what it means.
4. Give one point per word read and celebrate at the door!

💡 Real-world signs show children that reading is useful everywhere.

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐

🧊

Frozen Letter Rescue

📍 Kitchen or balcony ⏱️ 30 min (plus freezing) 👧 Ages 3–6

You need

- Plastic tub
- Foam or magnetic letters
- Water
- Salt
- Squeeze bottle of warm water

Steps

1. The night before, freeze some letters in a tub of water.
2. Pop the ice block onto a tray. Sprinkle salt and squirt warm water to melt it.
3. As each letter is rescued, say its sound and think of a word that starts with it.
4. Can you build a word with the rescued letters?

💡 A perfect cool-down for a hot Dubai afternoon.

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐



Pillow-Fort Reading Den

📍 Living room ⏱ As long as you like 👧 Ages 3–8

You need

- Cushions, sheets, clothes pegs
- A torch
- Favourite books

Steps

1. Build a cosy fort together using the sofa and dining chairs.
2. Switch off the lights and read inside by torchlight.
3. Take turns: you read a page, then your child reads a word or a page.
4. Make a 'Den Rules' sign and let your child write it.

💡 Shared reading in a special place builds a love of books.

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐



Sand-Tray Writing

📍 Balcony or table ⏱️ 15 min 👧 Ages 3–6

You need

- A baking tray
- Beach sand, salt or semolina
- A paintbrush

Steps

1. Bring a little sand back from your next beach trip (or use salt).
2. Spread it in the tray. Say a sound and write the letter with a finger.
3. Shake the tray gently to 'erase', then try the next one.
4. Older kids can write short words like cat, sun or map.

💡 Feeling letters with fingers helps them stick in memory.

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐



Supermarket Word Detectives

📍 Supermarket ⏱️ During shopping 👧 Ages 4–8

You need

- A shopping list written in big, clear letters
- A pencil

Steps

1. Write a short list together at home: milk, eggs, apples, bread.
2. At the shop, your child reads each item and finds it.
3. Look for the matching word on the packet and tick it off.
4. Bonus: find something that starts with 'b'.

💡 Choose 3–5 items for younger readers, more for older ones.

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐



Grow a Balcony Herb Garden

📍 Balcony or windowsill ⏱ 15 min, then daily 👧 Ages 3–8

You need

- Small pots
- Soil
- Mint or basil cuttings
- Lolly sticks and a marker

Steps

1. Plant the cuttings together and water them.
2. Write plant labels on lolly sticks: MINT, BASIL.
3. Keep a 'plant diary': draw and write one word each day (tall, green, new leaf).
4. Pick some mint for a fresh drink.

💡 Indoor shade in summer, balcony sun in winter.

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐



Paper Lantern (Fanoos) Craft

📍 Table ⏱ 30 min 👧 Ages 4–8

You need

- Coloured card
- Scissors
- Glue or tape
- Battery tea-light

Steps

1. Fold a card in half the long way and cut slits from the fold, stopping 2 cm from the edge.
2. Unfold, roll into a tube, and tape the ends. Add a handle strip.
3. Write a kind word on it: love, kind, share, friend.
4. Read 'Noor and the Neighbours' by lantern light, then gift one to a neighbour!

💡 Great for Ramadan, Eid, Diwali or any special night.

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐



Shadow-Puppet Theatre

📍 Bedroom wall ⏱ 30 min 👧 Ages 3–8

You need

- Black card
- Scissors
- Lolly sticks or straws
- A torch or phone light

Steps

1. Draw and cut out characters from a story: three pigs and a wolf, or a lion and a mouse.
2. Tape each one onto a stick.
3. Darken the room and shine the torch at the wall.
4. Retell the story together. Your child can be the narrator!

💡 Retelling stories builds understanding and vocabulary.

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐



Bath-Time Foam Letters

📍 Bathroom ⏱ 10 min 👧 Ages 3–6

You need

- Bath foam or plain shaving foam
- Bath tiles

Steps

1. Squirt foam onto the bath tiles and spread it flat.
2. Write a letter or word with a finger and ask your child to read it.
3. Swap: your child writes and you read.
4. Wipe away and start again.

💡 Keep it playful. Mistakes simply wipe away!

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐

📒

Make a Mini Book

📍 Table ⏱️ 30 min 👧 Ages 4–8

You need

- One sheet of A4 paper
- Scissors
- Crayons

Steps

1. Fold the paper into 8 squares, cut the middle slit, and fold it into a little book.
2. Write a title together, for example 'My Day in Dubai'.
3. Your child draws one picture per page and writes (or tells you) a sentence.
4. Read the finished book at bedtime.

💡 Children love reading words they wrote themselves.

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐



Float-a-Dhow Bath Boats

📍 Bathroom or kitchen sink ⏱ 20 min 👧 Ages 3–7

You need

- Clean juice cartons or sponges
- Straws
- Paper sails
- Tape

Steps

1. Make a boat from a carton or sponge with a straw mast and a paper sail.
2. Write a word on each sail: sun, sea, fish.
3. Float them and read each boat's name as it 'docks'.
4. Talk about the old dhows at Dubai Creek.

💡 Ask: Will it float or sink? Why?

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐



Hallway Word Obstacle Course

📍 Hallway or living room ⏱️ 20 min 👧 Ages 4–8

You need

- Paper cards
- Marker
- Cushions

Steps

1. Write action words on cards: hop, jump, crawl, spin, run.
2. Place them along a course of cushions.
3. Your child reads each card and does the action.
4. Mix in sight words for extra practice.

💡 Burns energy indoors when it's too hot outside.

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐



Weekend Outing Story Hunt

📍 Park, beach or desert (cooler months) ⏱ Outing 👧 Ages 3–8

You need

- Phone camera
- A small notebook

Steps

1. On a park, beach or desert trip, take 5 photos: a palm tree, a shell, sand, a bird, a camel.
2. At home, print or look at the photos together.
3. Your child tells a story using the photos, and you write it down.
4. Read the story back together. Add it to your Mini Book!

💡 Best from October to April, early in the morning.

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐



Snack-Time Sound Sort

📍 Kitchen ⏱ 10 min 👧 Ages 3–5

You need

- Small snacks: dates, grapes, apple slices, bread, crackers
- Two plates labelled with letters

Steps

1. Label one plate 'd' and one plate 'g'.
2. Say each snack's name: 'dates' starts with 'duh', so it goes on the d plate!
3. Try new letters: a for apple, b for bread.
4. Eat the snacks when the sorting is done!

💡 Hearing first sounds is the first step to reading.

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐



Bedtime Gratitude Jar

📍 Bedroom ⏱ 5 min nightly 👧 Ages 3–8

You need

- A clean jar
- Small paper strips
- A pencil

Steps

1. Each night, share one happy thing from the day.
2. Write it on a strip (younger ones can draw). Older kids write it themselves.
3. Fold it and pop it into the jar.
4. At the end of the month, read them all together.

💡 A calm, positive way to end the day, just like Ollie Owl.

We did it on: _____ ⭐⭐⭐